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Dear clients,

Macro has taken a back seat in crypto markets, as participants have focused their attention on President Trump's executive orders and policy initiatives. President Trump's first crypto-related executive order ("Strengthening American Leadership in Digital Financial Technology") signed on January 23 will create a cryptocurrency working group tasked with developing a crypto regulatory framework and evaluating the creation of a "national digital asset stockpile" among other things. Meanwhile, we parse the implications of Trump's newly launched memecoin, both for the industry as well as for the Solana ecosystem.

On the regulatory front, President Trump appointed Mark Uyeda as acting SEC chair before Paul Atkin's confirmation, and Commissioner Hester Peirce will lead a new crypto task force, which will be empowered to take a new direction at the agency. As their first course of action, the SEC repealed SAB 121 which previously made it infeasible for banks to custody crypto. Note that the timing coincides with the first round of deadlines for multiple spot SOL ETFs in the US, which could provide more insight into how the SEC will approach future crypto-related regulatory measures.

Separately, Ethereum now has a tentative date for its upcoming Pectra fork on March 11, 2025 that will introduce a number of key changes to increase max validator balances, improve user experiences, and set an overall stronger technological foundation for the network. At the same time, the Ethereum Foundation is also exploring utilizing a subset of its ETH treasury actively on decentralized finance protocols like Aave, though this comes amidst a potential shakeup in the Ethereum Foundation's leadership structure.

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The Coinbase Institutional Team

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70 Sir John Rogerson's Quay | Dublin 2 | D02 R296 | Ireland

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